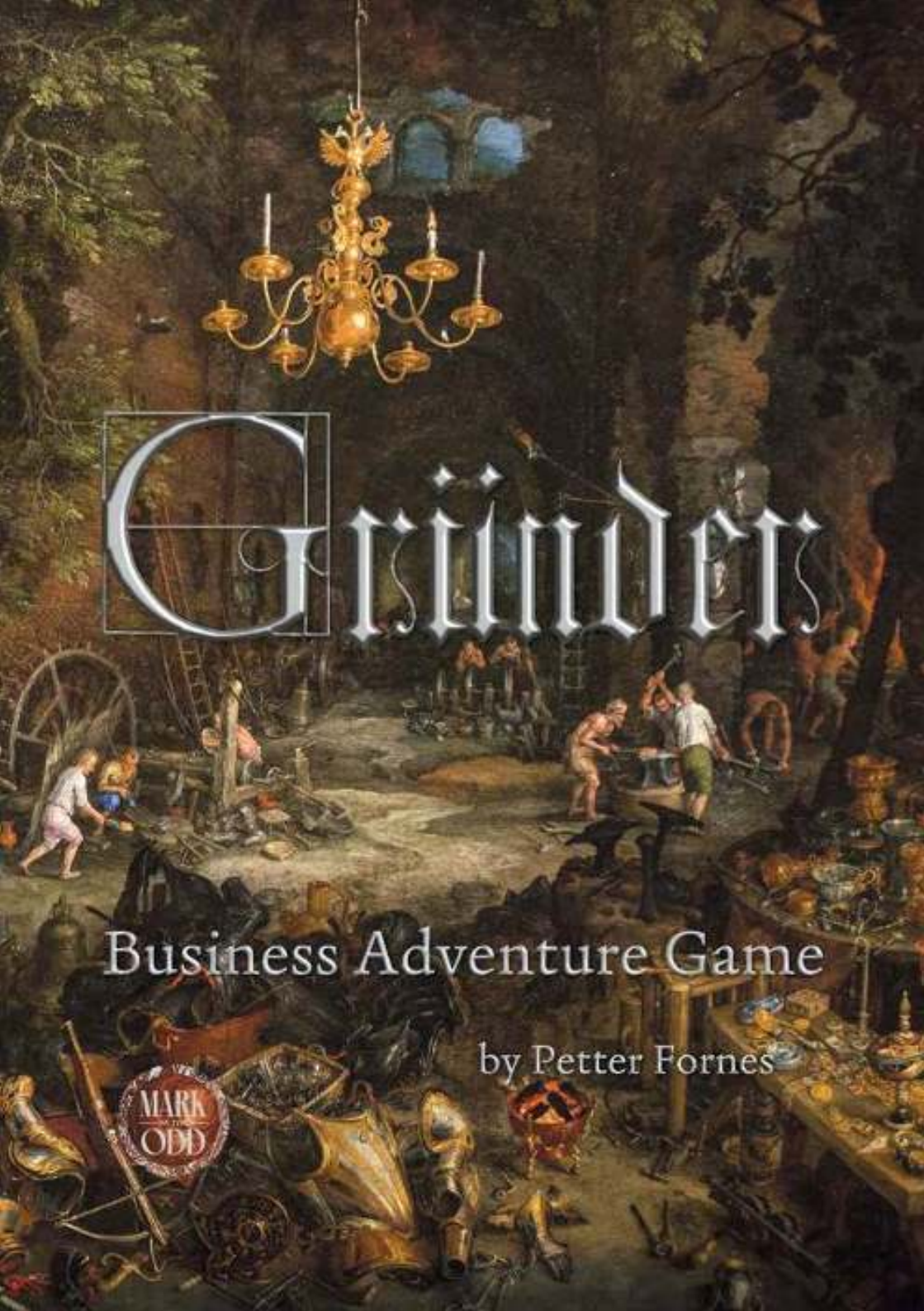




Grinders

Business Adventure Game

by Petter Fornes



Gründer

Writing, design and layout by Petter
Fornes and published by RR1 Publishing.

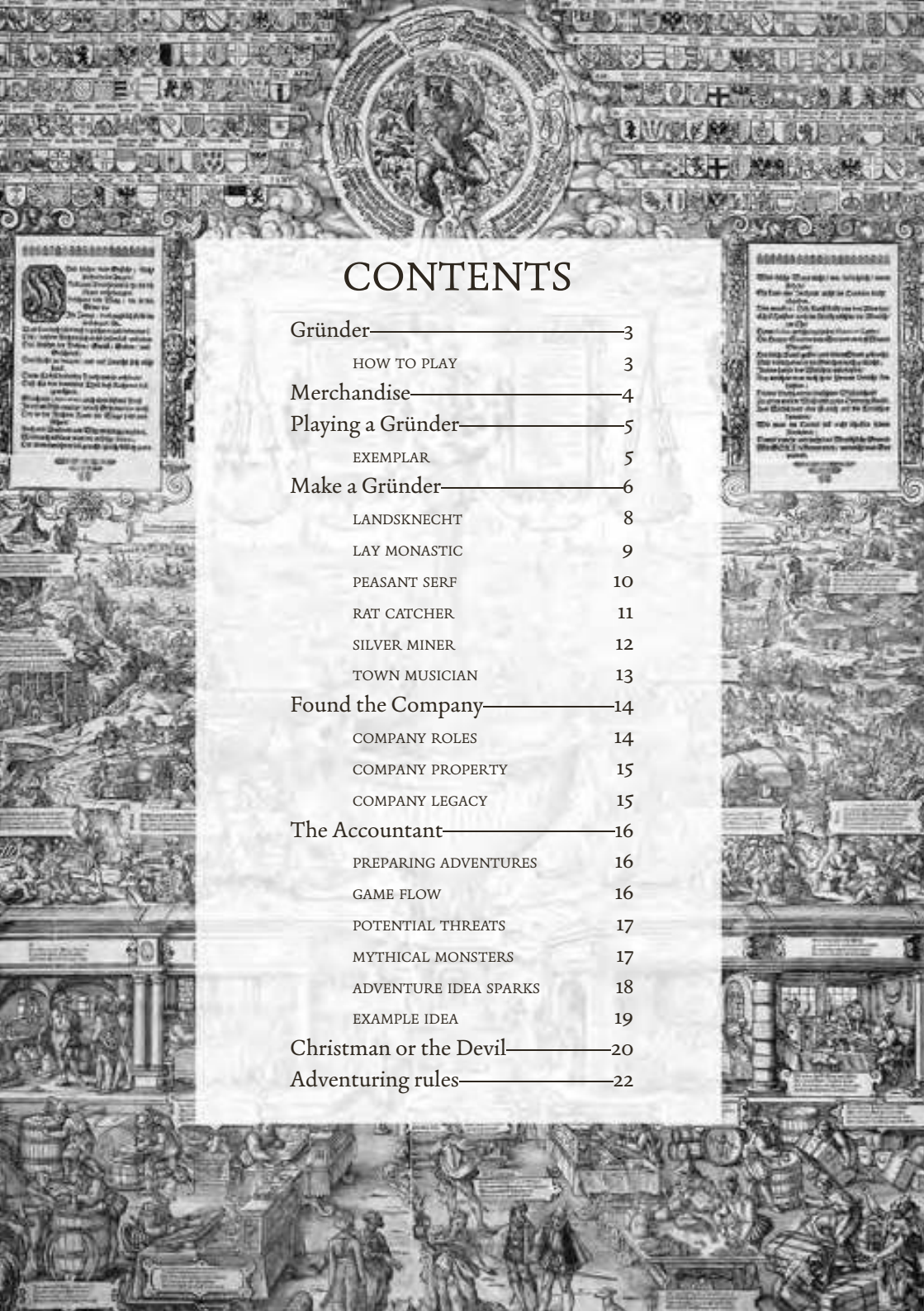
Rules from Into the Odd are used of which Chris

McDowall is the original creator, www.bastionland.com.

Art by Jan Brueghel, Albrecht Dürer, Jacques de Gheyn,
Rembrandt and other great artists, all in the public domain.

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G⁺ründer

A Gründer is someone who founds a new business. Gründer is a game about a group of ambitious people who have started a company together. In play these Gründers go on a dangerous adventure, to raise the capital they need to realise their business idea. How much treasure they acquire affects the long term success chances of the company, and the legacy of the Gründers.

The backdrop setting of Gründer is the 16th century Holy Roman Empire, with a touch or more of mythical elements.

HOW TO PLAY

Suitable for 3–6 players. One player takes the role of the Accountant, who prepares an adventure and runs the game (p16). The other players each play one astute Gründer (p6). Together they form a Company (p14). Their goal is to secure funds (p15). To do so they need to explore, scheme and play smart.

The Accountant describes the world and situation, providing information. The Gründers describe what they do in the situations they find themselves in. The Accountant adjudicates their actions (rules on p22), determines the consequences as a neutral party, and narrates how the situation changes.

The game is intended for playing a one-shot adventure, perhaps a favourite module, ending with the Gründers switching focus to their actual business. When they are ready to settle down the Gründers roll a pool of dice, and its size depends on the amount of treasure found (p15). Based on the outcome, one player narrates an epilogue of how the real business adventure turns out.

Merchandise

Improvised weapon: rocks, fists, teeth, kicks, etc (d4 Damage)	Free
Farm implement: scythe, flail, billhook, etc (d6 Damage, Bulky)	1 Thaler
Simple weapon: dagger, mace, dusack cutlass, etc (d6 Damage)	2 Thalers
Polearm: halberd, pike, partisan spear, etc (d8 Damage, Bulky)	10 Thalers
Windlass crossbow (d8 Damage, Bulky)	25 Thalers
Warfare weapon: fine sword, battle axe, etc (d8 Damage)	30 Thalers
Armour breaker: war hammer, panzerstecher, etc (d6 Damage, ignore armour)	40 Thalers
Arquebus (d10 Damage, Bulky, Slow)	50 Thalers
Cannon (d12 Damage, Bulky, Slow, towed on limber cart)	200 Thalers
Shield (+1 Armour, Bulky)	10 Thalers
Brigandine armour (Armour 1, Bulky)	25 Thalers
Cuirass and helmet (Armour 1)	50 Thalers
Munition three-quarters armour (Armour 2, Bulky)	100 Thalers
“Maximilian” fluted plate armour (Armour 3, Bulky, needs fitting)	200 Thalers
Tools: hammer, lockpicks, ladder, shovel, string, chalk, caltrops, etc	1 Thaler
White wine barrel (Bulky)	10 Thalers
Aqua fortis bottle (nitric acid d6 Damage, burns until rinsed, highly corrosive)	10 Thalers
Black powder keg (Bulky, explosion d10 Damage, Blast, smoke)	20 Thalers
Arsenic per dose (lose d20 STR if consumed)	20 Thalers
Luxuries: noble’s outfit, thermometer, pocket watch, etc	100 Thalers
Production equipment: printing press, glass works, spirits still, etc	200 Thalers
Transportation: wheelbarrow / cart / wagon	5 / 30 / 100 Thalers
Ships: row boat / river barge / caravel	50 / 200 / 1000 Thalers
Dogs: schnauzer / dachshund / rottweiler (STR 2d6, bite d6 Damage)	1 / 2 / 5 Thalers
Livestock: sheep / swine / milking cow (STR 11) / ox (STR 16)	1 / 2 / 6 / 10 Thalers
Horses: mule / draft horse / war horse (STR 15, trample d8 Damage)	5 / 10 / 100 Thalers
Hired hands, wages per expedition paid up front:	
farmboy (d6 HP, STR 2d6, WIL 2d6, club d6 Damage)	1 Thaler
landsknecht (2d6 HP, Armour 1, halberd d8 Damage)	5 Thalers
artisan (d6 HP, sword d6 Damage, specialised skill)	10 Thalers

Playing a Gründer

9 theses for Gründer players to dispute:

PURSuing THE GOAL, working to get treasure, must be done to succeed.

TAKING ACTION is necessary, as the Accountant is not expected to help you.

DESCRIBING your actions cleverly and creatively makes you incur lower risk.

EXPLORING the locations and interacting with people you meet is wise.

ASKING QUESTIONS will lead you to find secrets and hidden things.

AVOIDING COMBAT if you can, or fighting dirty if you must, is smart to survive.

RUNNING AWAY from foes, preferably with their loot, is an ideal option.

HELPING each other and collaborating will improve your odds of prospering.

LISTENING and caring helps everyone around the table to be comfortable.

EXEMPLAR

Character sheet available: www.drivethrurpg.com/en/product/555680/gruender-business-adventure-game

Gründer

NAME Jorg Bauer
CHARACTERISTIC Gaunt
REPUTATION Reckless

STRENGTH 12
DEXTERITY 13
WILLPOWER 15

HIT PROTECTION 2
THALERS 3
OLD CAREER Lay monk

Fetches water for the monastery brewery. Studied new innovations of spirit production. Spokesperson and founder of brewery Affenbräu.

EQUIPMENT

Loose robes
Bible
Ink and quill
Bucket
Jug with distilled grape spirit

Make a Gründer

Roll two d6 for each of:

NAME	First name and last name
CHARACTERISTIC	What sets you out in a crowd
REPUTATION	What other people say about you

Roll 3d6 for each Ability Score:

(STR) STRENGTH	Physique, martial prowess, grit
(DEX) DEXTERITY	Speed, reflexes, handiness
(WIL) WILLPOWER	Confidence, self-control, authority

Roll a d6 for each of:

(HP) HIT PROTECTION	Ability to avoid damage in combat
THALERS	Silver coins, your starting capital
OLD CAREER	Your life and work experience

Note the equipment you have from your old career. Take the additional items based on your highest rolled Ability Score (HIGH SCORE) and your rolled Hit Protection (HP). Answer the questions, and interpret your history from the items. Introduce the Gründer to the other players.

d6	OLD CAREER	
1	Landsknecht	p8
2	Lay monastic	p9
3	Peasant serf	p10
4	Rat catcher	p11
5	Silver miner	p12
6	Town musician	p13



d6	FIRST NAME		d6	LAST NAME	
1	Contz	or Els	1	Bauer	
2	Hanns	or Engel	2	Braun	
3	Heintz	or Gertrudt	3	Bremer	
4	Jorg	or Margret	4	Fischer	
5	Jost	or Metze	5	Krieger	
6	Ott	or Walpurg	6	Schmidt	

d66	CHARACTERISTIC				
11	Bald	31	Hairy mole	51	Red cheeks
12	Beautiful	32	Handsome	52	Rough hands
13	Beer belly	33	Heavy jaw	53	Scalds
14	Black fingernails	34	Large ears	54	Seven foot tall
15	Broken teeth	35	Long nose	55	Short cut hair
16	Bull-necked	36	Missing ring finger	56	Squat
21	Coal black mane	41	Muscular arms	61	Stained hands
22	Curly locks	42	Mustache or braids	62	Sweaty
23	Emaciated	43	Pale complexion	63	Tanned
24	Fishy smell	44	Pig eyes	64	Throat scar
25	Fleshy lips	45	Plump	65	White hair
26	Gaunt	46	Pox scars	66	Wide grin

d66	REPUTATION				
11	Ambitious	31	Gullible	51	Rightous
12	Cocky	32	Honest	52	Rude
13	Cunning	33	Hot-blooded	53	Scheming
14	Curious	34	Ingenious	54	Self-sacrificing
15	Cutthroat	35	Kind-hearted	55	Serious
16	Devious	36	Loyal	56	Shrewd
21	Eccentric	41	Opportunistic	61	Stiff-necked
22	Envious	42	Optimistic	62	Stingy
23	Foolhardy	43	Pious	63	Trustworthy
24	Frivolous	44	Prideful	64	Vain
25	Glutton	45	Prolific	65	Vicious
26	Greedy	46	Reckless	66	Vindictive

LANDSKNECHT

You were a servant of the land, fighting as a mercenary for the Emperor, or for the highest bidder.

You have a colourful puff and slash outfit, a feathered hat, and a katzbalger sword (d6 Damage). Take a weapon and a trophy, and answer the questions.

HIGH SCORE	WEAPON
3–11	Zweihander (d10 Damage, Bulky)
12	Arquebus (d10 Damage, Bulky, Slow)
13	Halberd (d8 Damage, Bulky)
14	Pike (d8 Damage, Bulky)
15	Kriegsmesser knife (d6 Damage)
16–18	Field drum

How many people have you slain?

HP	TROPHY
1	Polished armour (Armour 2, Bulky)
2	Dented cuirass (Armour 1, Bulky)
3	Manacles
4	Dull bone saw
5	Brass nose
6	Groin scar

What happened in your last battle?



LAY MONASTIC

You lived a disciplined life in a monastery, yet were never ordained as a monk or nun.

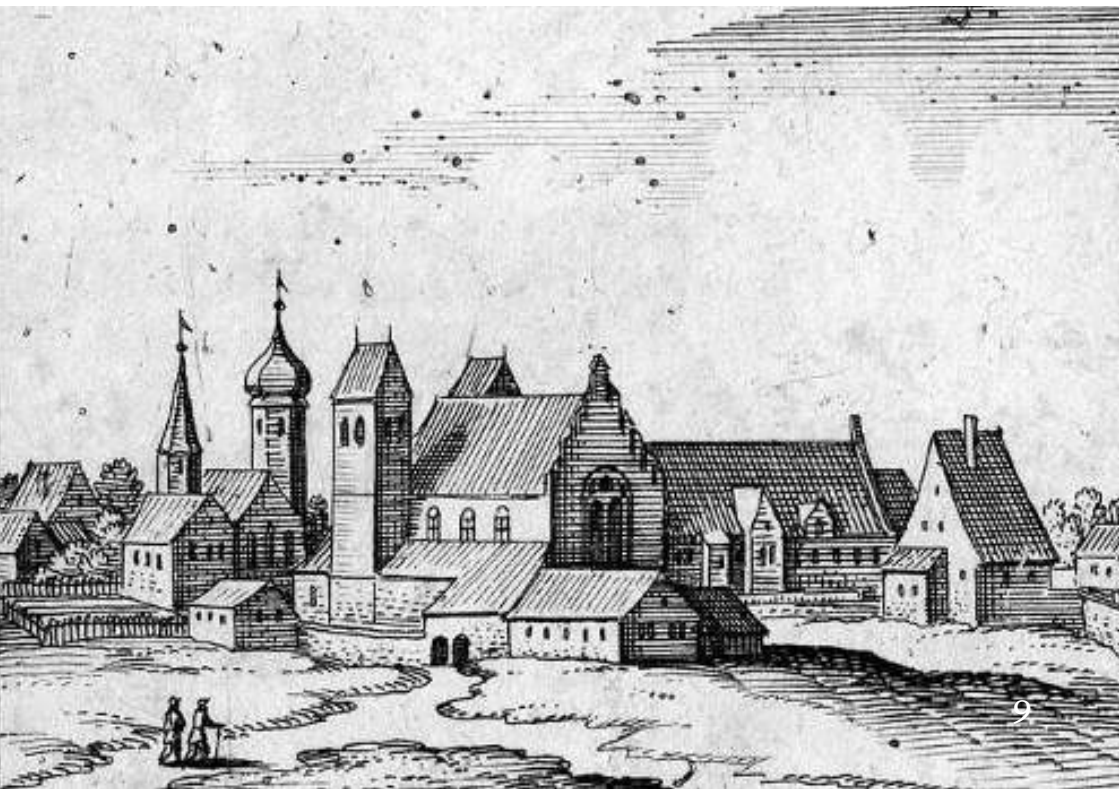
You have loose robes, a bible, ink and quill. Take a utensil and an article, and answer the questions.

HIGH SCORE	UTENSIL
3–11	Whip (d6 Damage)
12	Meat cleaver (d6 Damage)
13	Mattock (d6 Damage, Bulky)
14	Medicinal plants (numbing, toxic)
15	Bucket
16–18	Wine bottle

Which chores were your daily duties?

HP	ARTICLE
1	Saltpetre pouch
2	Jug with distilled grape spirit
3	Bandages
4	Encyclopedia (Bulky)
5	Glass lens
6	Celestial map

Which new art did you study?



PEASANT SERF

You ran a small subsistence farm, bound to the land of your lord, toiling in their fields.

You have a worn woolen tunic, a sturdy stick (10 ft), and a pitchfork (d6 Damage, Bulky). Take a product and an implement, and answer the questions.

HIGH SCORE	PRODUCT
3–11	Old tired mare (STR 9)
12	Stubborn sow (STR 13)
13	Pot of schmaltz, chicken fat
14	Sack with malted barley (Bulky)
15	Sheep shears
16–18	Bag of dried peas

What was the pride of your farm?

HP	IMPLEMENT
1	Guisarme (d8 Damage, Bulky)
2	Razor-sharp sickle (d6 Damage)
3	Chain (5 ft)
4	Bow saw
5	Bag pipe
6	Brand mark

How did you break your bonds?



RAT CATCHER

You did the dirty jobs for the fine folks, work beneath their dignity, keeping their homes free of vermin and pests.

You have a patchy fur coat, a skinning knife (d6 Damage) and a staff with a cage (d6 rats). Take a hunting device and a luxury, and answer the questions.

HIGH SCORE	HUNTING DEVICE
3–11	Fat, fierce cat (STR d6, d4 Damage)
12	Strychnine (lose d12 STR if ingested)
13	Tame pet rat
14	Catch pole
15	Smoked sausage links
16–18	Recorder flute

What did you do with your prey?

HP	LUXURY
1	Lever crossbow (d6 Damage, Bulky)
2	Grappling hook
3	Bag of rye flour
4	Minced meat pie
5	Silver-coated crucifix
6	Perfume

Who were your regular clients?

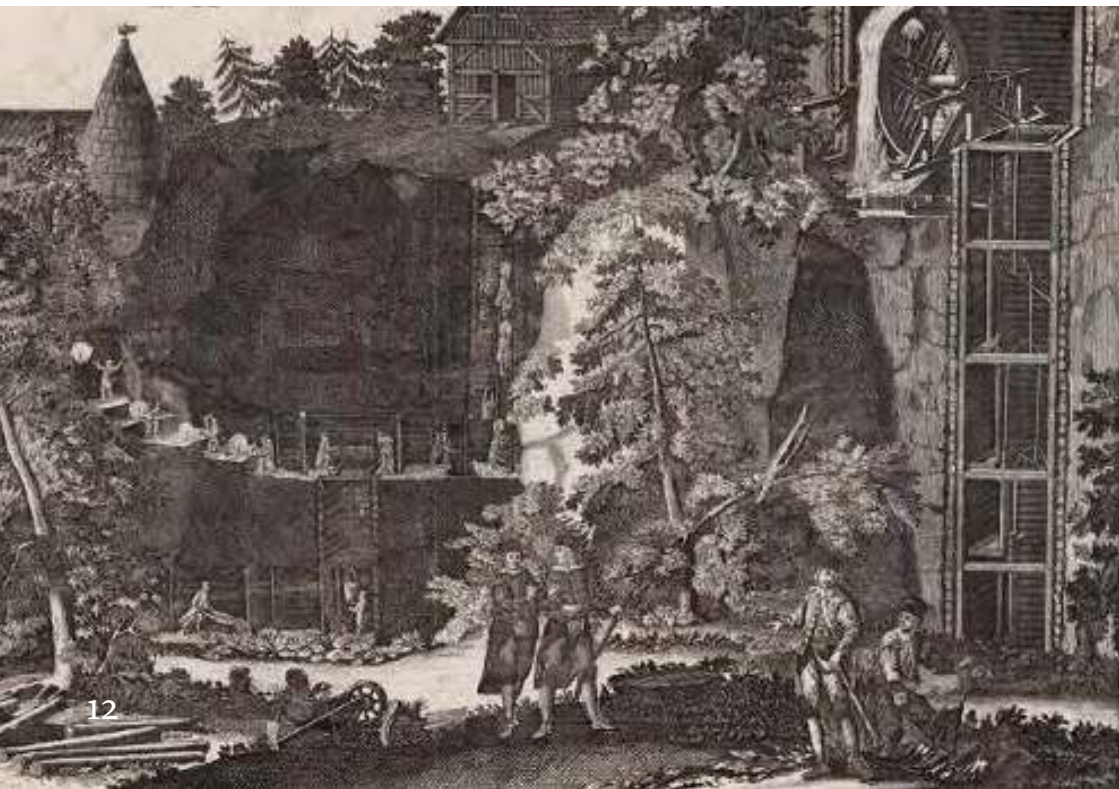


SILVER MINER

You laboured for a mining company, slaving in the darkness and the choking air underground for others' profit.

You have well-mended pit trousers, a leather apron, and a pick axe (d6 Damage, Bulky). Take a work tool and a prize, and answer the questions.

HIGH SCORE	WORK TOOL	HP	PRIZE
3–11	Sledgehammer (d8 Damage, Bulky)	1	Poleaxe (d8 Damage, Bulky)
12	Wheelbarrow (Bulky)	2	Pry bar and rusty nails
13	Mallet and chisel	3	Stamped silver ingot (50 Thalers)
14	Hand drill and chalk	4	Lead sheet
15	Charcoal and bellows	5	Salt crystal block
16–18	Dowsing rod	6	Five fingers
What was your specialized work task?		What made you leave the mine?	



TOWN MUSICIAN

You spread joy in hamlets and entertained citizens in the big towns, living from hand to mouth.

You have puffy breeches, an extravagant cape, and a sharp dagger (d6 Damage). Take a donation and instruments, and answer the questions.

HIGH SCORE	DONATION
3–11	Donkey (STR 10)
12	Fishing net
13	Signet ring, noble family
14	Rooster (STR d4, d4 Damage)
15	Pumpnickel loaf
16–18	Basket with rotten apples

What kind of crowd enjoyed your show?

HP	INSTRUMENTS
1	Lute and lockpicks
2	Shawm flute and pincers
3	Slide trumpet and tambourin
4	Tabor drum and bladder fiddle
5	Horn and cymbal
6	Contrabass (Bulky) and bells

What was your role in the ensemble?



Found the Company

Before going on an adventure the Gründers must found the Company. First the players determine together how the Gründers know each other. Next the players decide on a type of business, and how they got the idea. Finally, they name their Company.

d6	BUSINESS TYPE	IDEA SPARK
1	Farm	Artistic vision
2	Mining works	Competition
3	Newspaper	Espionage
4	Tavern	Invention
5	Theater	Necessity
6	University	Rumour

COMPANY ROLES

EXECUTOR: make snap group decisions

LOGISTICIAN: draw maps, know position

TREASURER: keep track of treasure found

SECRETARY: take notes of information

SPOKESPERSON: approach people friendly

SCOUT: look out for new opportunities



Divide the roles among the Gründers. One player chooses a role and elects someone else to have it. They go on next, repeat until all roles are filled. Each role gives their player a special responsibility in the game, and they permit the Accountant to make swiping assumptions for faster play. By default the Scout notices new encounters, the Spokesperson rolls Reaction (p22) for first impressions, the Executor calls for a retreat, and so on. The Gründers may redistribute the roles upon a majority vote.

Company

COMPANY NAME Affenbräu
 BUSINESS IDEA Brew and sell beer
 EXECUTOR Walpurg
 LOGISTICIAN Els
 TREASURER Walpurg
 SECRETARY Els
 SPOKESPERSON Jorg
 SCOUT Jost

SIGNATURES

Walpurg Bauer Jorg Bauer
 Jost Braun Els Fischer

COMPANY PROPERTY

The Company starts with a modest supply of ropes, oil lamps and food.

COMPANY LEGACY

The real business starts at the end of the game, when the Gründers are done adventuring. The more treasure secured, the better the odds for the Company.

During play the Treasurer collects a pool of dice:

- + Add one d6 for every 100 silver Thalers worth accumulated
- + Add two d6 for every useful asset secured, e.g. cutting edge technology, valuable secrets, new business contacts, location, location, and location
- Remove one d6 for every new Gründer incorporated into the Company after its founding, i.e. the cost of bringing more shareholders in after deaths

After the adventure, the players elect who will tell an epilogue narrating how the Company prospers, or not. They shall gather the d6 dice pool, roll and count the TOTAL number of sixes, and then narrate the epilogue accordingly:

TOTAL	THE COMPANY LEGACY
0	The Company fails spectacularly. All the funding goes down the drain, without the business getting off the ground. Back to poverty.
1	The Company keeps afloat for a while, but is unable to grow and return the investment. Shutdown when the founders are sick and tired of it all.
2	The Company provides well enough for daily bread and butter. Everything falls apart when the founders pass away and their heirs take over.
3	The Company earns good money. When the business is sold to a bigger actor, the founders secure a luxurious pension for themselves.
4	The Company rises to regional dominance, and the founders become filthy rich. Outcompeted when a new disruptive technology enters the field.
5+	The Company turns into a global corporation, lasting until human society breaks down and everything crashes and burns.

The Accountant

Tell rumours to entice seeking out adventure. Provide INFORMATION, but let the players make the conclusions. Invite follow-up questions, but the players need to act to get answers (p5). Warn of threats, not necessarily in an obvious manner. The more danger, the clearer the clues.

Let players make their own CHOICES, clever or stupid, but make sure they are informed decisions. If the players hesitate, help summarise their options, suggest either or. Indicate what will happen if succeeding or failing a Save (p22). For both outcomes match the consequences to the situation: how serious it is, the approach taken, and leverage the players have.

Let the players' actions have a notable IMPACT, but try to remain a neutral party in the conflict between the world and the players. Do not make their life easier or more difficult than is warranted by the situation details. If a Gründer dies, ask the player to make a new one and incorporate them quickly into the Company (p15).

PREPARING ADVENTURES

Before play begins the Accountant should prepare an adventure. Use a module or roll on tables for inspiration (p18). Visualise a situation and establish some details; locations, people, creatures, a cost for spending time, and where treasure is. A total of 1000 Thalers is a good baseline, most of it can be had with smart play or high risks. Do not plan what will happen; improvise in play what makes logical sense from what is established.

GAME FLOW

Preparation

PREPARE ADVENTURE
MODULE OR SPARKS
PRINT MATERIALS

Start of session

ADVENTURE PREMISE
SET EXPECTATIONS
CREATE GRÜNDERS
INTRODUCTIONS
FOUND THE COMPANY

Adventure

PRESENT SITUATION
INFORMATION
PLAYER ACTION
ADJUCATION
CONSEQUENCE
NEW SITUATION
RINSE AND REPEAT

End of game

REACH CONCLUSION
ASSESS TREASURE
ROLL DICE POOL
TELL THE EPILOGUE

POTENTIAL THREATS

All Ability Scores not listed are 10.

ROBBER (desperate, makes demands)
3 HP, crossbow or spear d6 Damage

KNIGHT (seeking glory, brutal)
9 HP, Armour 3, STR 13, WIL 13, heavy sword d8 Damage

PIKE FORMATION (comrades in arms)
7 HP, Armour 1, pike wall d12 Damage, Blast (d8 against Detachments)
- Ten landsknechts strong, disciplined.
- Detachment: Attacks against the formation are Impaired unless they have Blast. Critical Damage causes the formation to break and route.

WOLF (cunning, voracious)
4 HP, STR 8, sharp teeth d6 Damage
- Critical Damage: Jaws grip victim's throat tightly, reduce STR by d4.

BEAR (hungry, curious)
10 HP, Armour 1, STR 15, paw d10 Damage

RHINOCEROS (stoic, territorial)
15 HP, Armour 3, STR 17, WIL 14, pointy nose horn d12 Damage
- Critical Damage: Victim is impaled, dragged along dangling like a rag doll.

MYTHICAL MONSTERS

DEVIL (pretty, double-crossing)
4 HP, WIL 15, sword d8 Damage, Immune to non-silver Damage
- Critical Damage: Stabs the soul of the victim, reduce WIL by d12.

GEIST (unrestful, single-minded)
1 HP, WIL 17, Immune to physical Damage
- Matter passes through its lifelike form.
- Looks like when it died, voice as aged.
- Haunt: A target is Deprived until the Geist is appeased or banished (WIL 0).

MIINE KOBOLD (sadistic, proud)
7 HP, STR 6, rock hammer d6 Damage
- Speech sounds like echoing booms.
- Appears as flickering candle from afar, like a 2 ft hunched, ugly miner up close.
- Walks through rock. Starts cave-ins.

MOSS PEOPLE (wild, protective)
5 HP, Armour 1, tree root d6 Damage
- Mossy fur, can hide inside trees.

SEA SWINE (heretical, evil gaze)
13 HP, Armour 2, eye beams d12 Damage
- Marine pig covered with scales, with dragon's feet and wide eyes at its hips.

TWO-BODIED BOAR (self-pitying, rage)
9 HP, STR 14, gore d10 Damage
- First time Critically Damaged: The second body fights on, Impaired.

ADVENTURE IDEA SPARKS

d6	RUMOUR	ADVENTURE
1	A monstrous hog was born in Landser, it's an ill omen	Exploration
2	An alchemist claims to have made a revolutionary discovery	Heist
3	No one can resist cavorting, a dance plague has broken out	Infiltration
4	Old myths say an ancient gold treasure was lost in the water	Investigation
5	One Sunday morning all the children were disappeared	Raid
6	Truchsess von Waldburg was lynched, a revolt is brewing	Search

d6	ENVIRONMENT	LOCATION	ANGER	TREASURE
1	Alpine mountains	Abandoned mine	Burning fires	Artwork
2	Bustling city	Camp site	Extreme weather	Gemstones
3	Fertile farmlands	Gothic church	Mythic monster	Ransom
4	Isolated village	Hilltop castle	Pillaging brigands	Sacred relic
5	Wide river	Opulent abbey	Virulent disease	Silver coin
6	Windy coastline	Roman ruins	Wild beasts	Technology

d6	PERSON: CLIENT, RIVAL, ALLY OR ENEMY	TWIST
1	Bishop Albrecht, corrupt gambler, working political scheme	Betrayal
2	Ursel Schneider, struggling merchant in debt, cutting corners	Competition
3	Fricz, huntsman, meager catch, does anything to feed family	Conspiracy
4	Gräfin Kathrin, noble trying to do good, religiously intolerant	Monstrosity
5	Ro the fool, overheard secrets at court, wants to cause chaos	Puzzle
6	Ruger, remorseful mercenary, working against noble house	Sad truth

EXAMPLE IDEA

RUMOUR: A serial killer works the area

ADVENTURE: Race

ENVIRONMENT: Black forest

LOCATION: Cave complex

DANGER: Ruthless soldiers

TREASURE: Trade goods

CLIENT: Cooper, learned, resolute

RIVAL: Knight, high status, arrogant

ALLY: Bandit, opportunistic, jaded

ENEMY: Devil, charismatic, horrible

TWIST: Dilemma

IDEA: A race to get to a treasure hoard before a troop of soldiers—a serial killer's stash hidden in cave tunnels.

Now add details, short is sufficient. Note what is obvious (in parentheses what requires interaction to learn). Spending time should incur a cost; opt for rolling for random events, instead of a timeline or countdown.

To provide a choice of route, offer the long road the soldiers took or a potential shortcut through the black forest. Detours can lead to valuable information or extra treasure. Navigational agency is helped by drawing a simple map, showing where locations are in relation to each other. Include likely routes between them, and what is in the area around, to aid improvisation.

People to interact with can comprise an evil serial killer, potential helpers like ex-robbers and -landsknechts. In addition groups that can be talked to, fought with or put against each other, like knights and moss people.

To form an open-ended problem to solve the loot access is blocked by a group of formidable knights. A dilemma may be provoked by tempting cooperation with the devil antagonist, at possible grave cost.

Christman or the Devil

This adventure is inspired by a grim tale from 1581, allegedly true. For seven years the serial killer Christman has terrorized the Bergkessel area. Yesterday the respected cooper Anna Küpper burst into the market square. She had been kidnapped, but managed to escape from the wicked Christman. She now leads a group of knights back to his cave in Frassberg to seize him. A troop of thirty dour landsknechts just marched out to annex his loot.

Hurry up, get there first and grab something of value before the troop arrives!



Creature stats on p17

LANDSKNECHT TROOP, marching 0 to 5
 - 3 Pike Formations, thirty men (greedy)
 - Reaching 5 CAVE COMPLEX: they secure all valuables, threatening anyone there to surrender or risk violence (game over?)

0 BERGKESSEL, provincial, waterlogged

trails (criss-cross)

GRÜNWALD

9 MIGHTY OAK, rises above other trees
 - Lean-to shelter (embers, hoof prints)
 - Broken branches (skeleton grown into trunk, a skull peaks out between stems)
 - Luscious acorns (sweet taste of vanilla, when eaten skin becomes tough as bark: gain Armour 2, reduce DEX by d6)

7 BREAKING WHEEL, in view on high hill
 - A broken man is mercy-killed by Rote Rupert (Robber, scared of Christman, eager to sell secrets: at 6 CAVE BACKDOOR close eyes and sing to pass unharmed, in 8 FOREST GLADE there is a buried treasure)

1 CROSSROAD, well-trodden main road
 - Road sign (Trier-Bergkessel-Morbach, black nails of silver worth 30 Thalers)

forest path (muddy, little traffic)

TRIER

2 REST SITE, sheltered spot, birdsong
 - Burned wagon chars (iron barrel bands)

When the Company explores a location, moves between landmarks, or otherwise uses ample time, roll a d6: 1–3 Encounter (roll again on the table), 4–6 Landsknecht troop move +1, i.e. gradually from landmark locations 0 to 5

d6	ENCOUNTER (roll 2d6 pick low in forest, 2d6 pick high on main road)
1	Caught between Bear and her cub (5 HP, STR 8, bite d6), extremely protective
2	2d6 Moss People mad about vandalism, want to abduct and hang a human
3	Landsknecht Veyt is lost and eager to join a larger group, saw a tree moving
4	Injured Knight (STR 4), bloodied Ritter Linhart demands help to get back
5	Robber in black cloak, pretending to be Christman to rob people by fright
6	Mertin Weber, artisan weaver with cordage, blissfully unaware, saw knights

6 CAVE BACKDOOR, dark spot from afar
 - Rhythmic clanking (like wind chimes)
 - Three hanging dry bodies (3 Geists, youths with adult voices, want to see Christman dance/sing/play. To pass in peace: dance, sing or play to their rhythm)

8 FOREST GLADE, dead quiet, nettles
 - 3x3 ft plot of turned earth (buried man: on knees bent forward, blunt head trauma, hugging a sack with 117 Thalers)

3 ROCK OUTCROP, horses, blue banner
 - At the foot: 7 tied horses, 2 Knights guard a tied-up Christman (Devil, promises anything to be freed, if he kills 36 more people a portal to hell opens)
 - At summit: banner raised by huge stone (behind stone: a red door out of sight from the path; on top of stone: fantastic view and a telescope worth 100 Thalers)

hidden entrance (red door)

MORBACH

5 CAVE COMPLEX, paths winding down
 - Eroded chalk, skeletons and rotting bodies stuffed in alcoves. When sifting through remains of victims, roll a d6:
 1 Goods crate (Bulky, worth 70 Thalers)
 2 Pile of luggage (personal belongings, one item is an Asset for the Company)
 3 Decomposing bodies (luxuries and fine clothing worth 260 Thalers total)
 4–6 Landsknecht troop moves +1 closer

cave tunnels (rough)

FRASSBERG

4 SUBTERRANEAN MANSION, rancid smell
 - Compact manor house (no windows, tallow candles, fancy furnishing)
 - 5 Knights and 1 woman (Anna Küpper) are tossing the place (Ritter Cristoffel is in charge, worth 500 Thalers as ransom)
 - Piled goods (fine linen, gilded tankard, polished mirror, worth 240 Thalers total)
 - Hall wardrobe (hidden behind black coats is a simple door to 5 CAVE COMPLEX)
 - Book shelf (black log book written in brown ink: 964 tidy entries of names with manner of death, 36 empty rows)

Adventuring rules



Use these rules for exploration, danger, violence and recovery when adventuring.

SAVES: A Save is a roll to avoid danger from a risky action or situation. Roll a d20. If you roll equal or under the appropriate Ability Score you pass. 1 is always a success and 20 always a failure.

ABILITY SCORE LOSS: If a character has their **STR** score reduced to zero they are dead. If their **DEX** or **WIL** are reduced to zero the character is paralysed or mentally broken respectively, and cannot act until they have a Full Rest.

DEATH: When a Gründer dies the player creates a new Gründer and the Accountant finds a way to have them join the group as soon as possible. Here, quickness is required over realism. Alternatively the player may take control of an existing non-player character.

LUCK ROLLS: Sometimes you'll want an element of randomness without rolling a Save, particularly in situations dictated by luck or those that fall outside of the three Ability Scores. For these situations roll a d6. A high roll favours the players, and a low roll means bad luck for the players. The Accountant decides what a specific result means for the situation at hand.

REACTION: When the Company encounters another being, the Gründer at the head of the group must pass a **WIL** Save to avoid an unfavourable first reaction. Some encounters are always hostile, or always friendly, but all have potential to change after first contact.

TURNS: In a conflict the players generally take their turn before any enemies. If there is a risk of being surprised, Gründers must each roll a **DEX** Save or be unable to act on the first turn. On their turn, players can act in any order they wish.

ACTIONS: On your turn a Gründer can move and perform an action. An action can be anything from negotiating, to attacking, to fleeing. Attacks are detailed below. For other actions the Accountant calls for the character at risk to roll a Save. For example, an attempt to trip an opponent might force them to pass a **STR** Save to stay on their feet, while an attempt to trick an opponent into surrender may force them to pass a **WIL** Save or lower their arms.

ATTACKS: An attacker rolls a die dictated by their weapon, and subtracts the opponent's Armour score. Their attack causes this much Damage. Ranged weapons cannot be used in melee.

SLOW: Slow ranged weapons cannot be fired if one moves on the same turn.

IMPAIRED/ENHANCED: Attacks that are Impaired, such as firing through cover, or fighting while grappled, roll d4 Damage regardless of weapon.

Similarly, attacks that are Enhanced by a risky stunt or a helpless or vulnerable target, roll d12 Damage.

DAMAGE: When an individual takes Damage they lose that many HP. If they have no HP left, they are wounded, and any remaining Damage is removed from their STR score. They must then pass a STR Save to avoid Critical Damage.

CRITICAL DAMAGE: A character that takes Critical Damage is unable to take further action until they are tended to by an ally and have a Short Rest. If they are left for an hour without being tended to, they die.

BULKY: Items marked as Bulky generally require two hands or significant storage to carry. Bulky weapons require two hands to wield. Anybody carrying three or more Bulky items is reduced to 0 HP.

BLAST: Blast weapons cause Damage to all targets in an appropriate area, rolling separately for each. If in doubt as to how many targets are affected, roll the weapon's Damage die.

MORALE: Groups require a WIL Save to avoid being routed when they lose half of their total numbers. Groups with a leader may use the leader's WIL score in place of their own. Lone combatants must pass this Save when they are reduced to 0 HP. This applies to opponents and allies but not Gründers. Fleeing to safety under pursuit requires a DEX Save and a place to withdraw to.

SHORT REST: A few minutes of rest and a swig of water recovers all of a character's lost HP. Resting may waste time or attract danger.

FULL REST: A Full Rest requires a week of downtime at a comfortable location. This restores all Ability Scores.

DEPRIVED: Somebody deprived of a crucial need (e.g. food, water, or warmth) cannot benefit from Rests.

HAZARDS: Damage from falling rocks, explosions and other sources outside of normal combat ranges between d4 and d12, with d20 used only in special cases. Consider how it would affect an average person. A fall that is quite likely to injure an inexperienced character might cause d8 Damage but a huge rock that would crush most might do d12. Poison usually causes Ability Score loss. Effects like Blindness will Impair attacks and call for Saves to carry out usually simple actions.

Gründer

Gründer is a business adventure game for 3–6 players. You found a Company with fellow ambitious minds and go on a daring adventure to secure the funds you need. In the end, how much treasure you find will decide your Company's fate.

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